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RESEARCH DIVISION (CRD).

THE CRIMEAN PENINSULA

A Regional Literature Review of Population and Settlement (10000BC - 1400AD).

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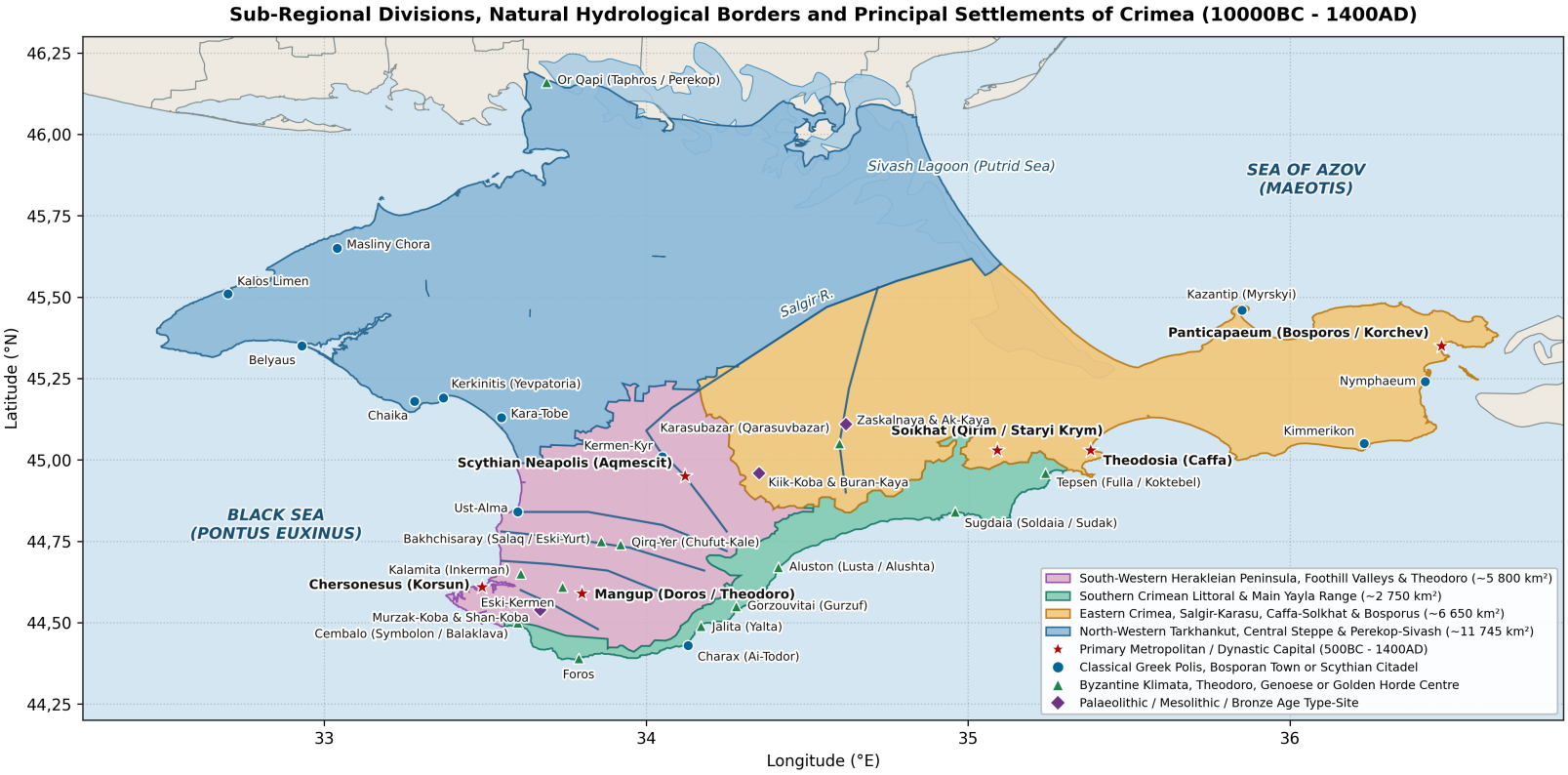


Figure 1. Natural sub-regions, river basins and principal prehistoric, classical and medieval settlements of Crimea (10000BC - 1400AD).

Abstract

This literature review compiles the demographic and settlement history of the Crimean Peninsula (*Taurica*, ~26.945 km^2 land area; 505 5-arcminute grid cells covering 30.488 km^2 including coastal cells) from the Final Pleistocene and Early Holocene (10000BC) to the late Golden Horde, Genoese and Theodorite benchmark of 1400AD (developments after 1400AD under the independent Crimean Khanate, the Ottoman Eyâlet of Kefe and the Russian Empire fall outside this period). Bounded by the Black Sea (*Pontus Euxinus*) to the west and south, the shallow Sea of Azov (*Palus Maeotis*) and the hypersaline Sivash lagoon system to the north-east and the Kerch Strait (*Kimmerian Bosporus*) to the east, Crimea connects to the Pontic steppe via the 7 km-wide Perekop Isthmus (*Taphros/Or Qapi*) and the narrow Arabat Spit. Internally, the peninsula divides along natural topographic and hydrological boundaries into three primary ecological belts: the northern and central dry-steppe plain (~72% of land area), the three parallel cuestas of the Crimean Mountains (the Outer, Inner and Main *Yayla* ranges, rising to 1.545 m at

Roman-Kosh) dissected by the Chorna, Belbek, Kacha, Alma, Salgir and Biyuk-Karasu valleys and the sheltered sub-Mediterranean southern littoral south-east of the Main Yayla crest.

Background

Following its topography, river basins and historical borders, Crimea divides into four physiographic sub-regions (Table 1). The South-Western Herakleian Peninsula, Premontane Valleys and Cave-Town Principality of Theodoro (~5.800 km² land area; 75 grid cells) is bounded on the south-east by the crest of the Western Main Yayla Ridge (north of the Baidar-Balaklava coastal scarp) and encompasses the Herakleian Peninsula (*Chersonesus Taurica*/*Korsun*), the Chorna, Belbek, Kacha, Alma and Upper Salgir foothill valleys, the cuesta table-mountains (*mesas*) of the Inner Range (Mangup-Doros, Eski-Kermen, Chufut-Kale/*Qirq-Yer*, Bakla, Tepe-Kermen, Kachi-Kalyon and Kalamita) and the Bakhchisaray and Simferopol (*Scythian Neapolis*) basins.

The Southern Crimean Littoral and Main Yayla Mountain Range (~2.750 km² land area; 33 grid cells) is bounded naturally on the north-west by the watershed crest of the Main Yayla Range (Ai-Petri, Yalta, Babugan, Chatyr-Dag, Demerdzhi and Karabi *Yaylas*), encompassing the narrow sub-Mediterranean coastal amphitheatres from Cembalo (Symbolon/Balaklava) and Foros eastward past Simeiz, Alupka, Charax, Oreanda, Jalita (Yalta), Gorzouvitai (Gurzuf), Partenit, Lambat and Aluston (*Lusta*/Alushta) to Sugdaia (*Soldaia*/Sudak); historically this zone was administered as the Byzantine *Parathalassia* (*Klimata*) and the Genoese *Capitanate of Gotthia*.

Eastern Crimea, the Salgir-Biyuk-Karasu Valley, the Caffa-Solkhat Basin and the Kerch Bosporus (~6.650 km² land area; 162 grid cells) is bounded on the north-west by the diagonal course of the Salgir River channel toward the Sivash lagoon, encompassing the Biyuk-Karasu valley (Karasubazar), the Golden Horde regional capital of Solkhat (*Qirim*/Staryi Krym), the Feodosia (*Theodosia*/*Caffa*) bay and Karadag-Koktebel (*Tepsen*) littoral and the European heartland of the Bosporan Kingdom on the Kerch Peninsula (Panticapaeum/*Bosporos*/*Korchev*, Nymphaeum, Myrmekion, Tyritake, Kimmerikon, Kytaia, Akra and the fortified rural *chora* behind the Uzunlarsky and Tyritake ramparts). Finally, the North-Western Tarkhankut Peninsula, Central Crimean Steppe and Perekop-Sivash Isthmus (~11.745 km² land area; 235 grid cells) is bounded on the south-east by the Salgir River channel and on the south by the Outer Cuesta foothills, encompassing the limestone coastline of the Tarkhankut Peninsula and the North-Western Chersonesean *chora* (Kerkinitis, Kalos Limen, Chaika, Belyaus, Panskoye I, Masliny, Kara-Tobe, Kulchuk and Tarpanchi), the central Crimean dry steppe and the northern fortified gateway at Perekop (*Taphros*/*Or Qapi*) and the Sivash lagoons.

Sub-Region	Area (% Share)	Principal Urban & Archaeological Centres	Key Benchmark Populations
South-Western Herakleian, Foothills & Theodoro	5.800 km² (21,5%)	Chersonesus (Korsun), Scythian Neapolis, Mangup (Theodoro), Qirq-Yer (Chufut-Kale), Eski-Kermen, Kalamita	17,5k (1000BC); 78k (200AD); 74k (900AD); 78k (1300AD); 62k (1400AD)
Southern Crimean Littoral & Main Yayla	2.750 km² (10,2%)	Cembalo (Symbolon), Foros, Charax, Jalita (Yalta), Gorzouvitai (Gurzuf), Partenit, Aluston, Sugdaia (Soldaia)	7k (1000BC); 19k (200AD); 36k (900AD); 46k (1300AD); 36k (1400AD)
Eastern Crimea, Caffa-Solkhat & Bosporus	6.650 km² (24,7%)	Panticapaeum (Bosporos/ Korchev), Theodosia (Caffa), Solkhat (Qirim), Karasubazar, Nymphaeum, Ilurat, Tepsen	13k (1000BC); 94k (200AD); 77k (900AD); 96k (1300AD); 65k (1400AD)

(Continued from previous page)

Sub-Region	Area (% Share)	Principal Urban & Archaeological Centres	Key Benchmark Populations
North-Western Tarkhankut & Central Steppe	11.745 km^2 (43,6%)	Kerkinitis, Kalos Limen, Belyaus, Panskoye I, Masliny, Chaika, Kara-Tobe, Kulchuk, Or Qapi (Taphros/Perekop)	10,5k (1000BC); 34k (200AD); 28k (900AD); 30k (1300AD); 22k (1400AD)
Total Crimean Peninsula (10000BC - 1400AD)	26.945 km^2 (100%)	171 Georeferenced Pre-1400AD Settlements in Regional Gazetteer	48k (1000BC); 225k (200AD); 215k (900AD); 250k (1300AD); 185k (1400AD)

Table 1. Physiographic and historical sub-regions of Crimea (26.945 km^2) with principal urban centres and benchmark populations (10000BC - 1400AD).

Results

Prehistory and the Early Iron Age (10000BC - 1000BC)

Mesolithic and Neolithic Foragers (10000BC - 5000BC)

During the Late Glacial and Early Holocene transition (10000BC - 8000BC), when the Black Sea stood 60 to 80 metres below its present level as the freshwater Neoeuxine lake, human settlement in Crimea concentrated in the sheltered limestone rock-shelters (*grottoes*) of the Inner Cuesta and Chornaya-Belbek-Kacha-Zuya river gorges [1][2]. Continuity from Upper Palaeolithic sites such as Buran-Kaya III (on the Burulcha River), Siuren I (on the Belbek), Kabazi II, Zaskalnaya and Kiik-Koba gave rise to two sequential Mesolithic archaeological complexes documented by G. A. Bonch-Osmolovsky, S. N. Bibikov and D. Ya. Telegin [3][4].

The Shan-Koba Culture (Final Pleistocene to Early Preboreal, c. 10000-7500BC) is characterised by lunate geometric microliths and intensive hunting of red deer, saiga antelope, wild boar and forest-steppe equids across rock-shelters at Shan-Koba, Fatma-Koba Layer 6, Grot Skalisty (on the Bodrak), Zamil-Koba I and Buran-Kaya III [3]. Across the peninsula's river canyons and expanded coastal plain, seasonal foraging bands (35 - 80 persons per multi-family rock-shelter aggregation) supported an estimated regional population of 1,2k (1.200) at 10000BC, rising to 2,1k (2.100) by 8000BC as Boreal warming expanded oak-pistachio woodlands across the foothill valleys.

The subsequent Murzak-Koba (Tardigravettian/Tardenoisian) Culture (7500-5500BC) and Crimean Neolithic (6000-5000BC) are documented by excavations at Murzak-Koba (in the Chornaya gorge, famous for its double Mesolithic burial showing ritual finger-phalange amputation), Fatma-Koba, Laspi VII on the southern coast, Tash-Air I in the Kacha canyon, Kaya-Arasy near Bakhchisaray, At-Bash on the Ai-Petri *Yayla* and Frontovoye I on the Kerch Peninsula. These assemblages demonstrate a shift toward trapeziform microliths, *Helix* land-snail harvesting, coastal fishing and incipient swine and ovicaprid domestication [1][3][4]. By 6000BC, Crimean population reached 3,5k (3.500), nearly doubling to 6,5k (6.500) at 5000BC with the establishment of permanent Neolithic open-air villages at Tash-Air I, Kaya-Arasy, Alekseevka on the Tarkhankut Peninsula and Frontovoye.

Bronze Age Pastoralists and the Tauri (4000BC - 1000BC)

Between 4000BC and 2000BC, Crimea became a contact zone between Pontic steppe kurgan pastoralists (Sredny Stog, Yamnaya and Catacomb cultures) and North Caucasian metalworking traditions [5][6]. During the Early and Middle Bronze Age (3200-2200BC), the indigenous Kemi-Oba Culture (named after the kurgan sanctuary near Bilohirsk excavated by A. A. Shchepinsky) occupied the premontane valleys from Sevastopol to the Salgir and Biyuk-Karasu basins. Kemi-Oba communities constructed timber-and-stone cist graves painted with polychrome ochre geometric friezes, erected anthropomorphic stone stelae (*Bakhchi-Eli* and *Kazanki*) and practised mixed valley-bottom agriculture and transhumant *Yayla* grazing [5][6]. Combining Kemi-Oba foothill settlements (7,5k in 3000BC and 12k in 2000BC in the south-western premontane zone) with Yamnaya and Catacomb kurgan groups across the Kerch Peninsula (Kamenka-Bosporan and Planerskoye) and Tarkhankut-Sivash steppes, total Crimean population rose from 11k at 4000BC to 22k at 3000BC and 35k at 2000BC.

During the Late Bronze Age and Early Iron Age transition (1500-800BC), Sabatinovka and Belozerka agricultural villages in the steppe coexisted with the Kizil-Koba Culture of the Crimean Mountains and foothills, identified by Kh. I. Kris and V. A. Kolotukhin with the historical Tauri (*Tauroi*) described by Herodotus (*Histories* IV.99-103) and Euripides [7][8][9]. Anchored by the 12 ha fortified promontory settlement of Uch-Bash overlooking the Chornaya mouth near Inkerman (0,9k - 1,2k inhabitants), the type-site of Kizil-Koba (*Krasnaya Peshchera*) in the Upper Salgir valley, Druzhnoye, Tash-Dzhargan and megalithic stone-box (*ashchechnye*) cemeteries across the Baidar valley and Southern Coast (Malorechenskoye, Oreanda, Simeiz and Gurzuf), the Tauri and pre-colonial steppe communities sustained a regional population of 48k (48.000) at 1000BC (17,5k in the south-western foothills, 7k along the southern coast, 13k in eastern Crimea and 10,5k across the north-western steppe).

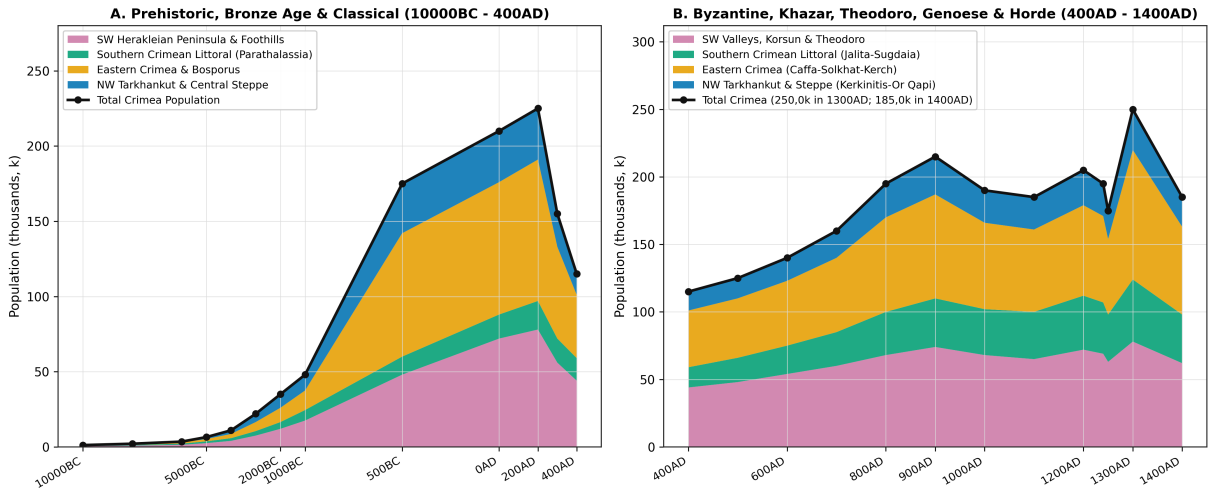


Figure 2. Population of Crimea across its four physiographic sub-regions from 10000BC to 1400AD.

Classical Antiquity (500BC - 400AD)

The Bosporan Kingdom and Chersonesus (500BC - 0AD)

Greek maritime colonisation in the sixth and fifth centuries BC triggered the first great demographic expansion in Crimean history, lifting total population from 48k in 1000BC to 175k in 500BC and 210k at 0AD [10][11][12]. Two distinct colonial systems reshaped the peninsula.

In the European Bosporus of eastern Crimea (82k at 500BC; 88k at 0AD; 94k at 200AD), Milesian colonists founded Panticapaeum (modern Kerch) on Mount Mithridates c. 600BC, which became the capital of the Archaeanactid (480BC) and Spartocid (438-108BC) dynasties of the Bosporan Kingdom. At its Classical-Hellenistic and early Roman zenith, Panticapaeum enclosed ~100 ha of terraced acropolis, agora, craft quarters and harbour suburbs housing 22k to 28k inhabitants [10][13]. Flanking the capital along the Kerch Strait and Azov-Black Sea coasts stood a dense urban network: Theodosia (annexed by Leucon I c. 380BC as a major grain-exporting port capable of berthing 100 ships, 6k at 500BC), Nymphaeum (4,5k), Myrmekion (3,5k), Tyritake (3,2k - 4k, famed for its fish-salting vats), Kimmerikon (2,5k - 3k), Kytaia (2,2k - 2,9k), Porthmion (1,8k), Akra (1,5k - 1,9k) and Zenon's Chersonesus (1,4k - 2,1k). Shielded behind the monumental earthen Tyritake and Uzunlarsky Ramparts (36 km long from the Sea of Azov to Lake Uzunlar), the Kerch interior supported over 280 rural estates and fortified towns (Andreevka-Yuzhnaya, Generalskoye-Zapadnoye, Polyanka, Zolotoe, Tasunovo, Mikhailovka, Artesian and Ilurat), supplying Athens with 400.000 *medimnoi* (~16.500 tonnes) of wheat annually under Leucon I [10][14].

In Dorian Chersonesus Taurica and the North-Western Crimean Chora (48k and 33k at 500BC), Heraclea Pontica founded Chersonesus Taurica in 422/421BC on Quarantine Bay (following an earlier sixth-century Ionian emporium). Chersonesus expanded across a 38 ha orthogonal grid enclosed by ashlar walls, supporting 4,5k inhabitants in 500BC and rising to 16k in 0AD and 20k in 200AD [15][16]. On the Herakleian Peninsula (~10.000 ha), G. M. Nikolaenko and J. C. Carter's surveys have mapped 415 stone-walled cadastral land-lots (*kleroi* of 26,5 ha each, subdivided into vineyards and orchards with fortified *pyrgoi* farmhouse towers), supporting an immediate suburban *chora* population of 6k - 8k [12][17]. In the mid-fourth century BC, Chersonesus incorporated the North-Western Crimean Chora along the Tarkhankut coast, including the older Ionian polis of Kerkinitis (Yevpatoria, 8,5 ha, 4,2k at 500BC), Kalos Limen (Chornomorske, 2,5k - 2,8k) and dozens of fortified coastal estates and grain-collecting stations at Panskoye I, Belyaus, Chaika, Masliny, Kara-Tobe, Kulchuk, Tarpanchi and Dzhangul [11][18][19].

Late Scythia and the Roman Protectorate (200BC - 400AD)

Under pressure from Sarmatian tribes crossing the Don in the third and second centuries BC, Royal Scythian elites consolidated the Late Scythian State in Crimea (*Scythia Minor*), establishing their fortified capital at Scythian Neapolis (*Kermen-Chuk*, a 20 ha stone-walled citadel on the Petrovskaya rocks in modern Simferopol, housing King Skilurus's mausoleum, megaron palace and ashlar granaries, with 7,5k - 8k inhabitants in 0AD - 200AD) [20][21][22]. Late Scythian kings Skilurus and Palakus overran the North-Western Chersonesean *chora* (occupying Kerkinitis, Kalos Limen, Chaika, Belyaus and Tarpanchi) and constructed a chain of over 50 fortified *gorodishcha* along the Alma, Kacha, Belbek and Salgir foothill rivers, led by the coastal port-citadel of Ust-Alma (Palakion, 6 ha, 3,5k - 4k), Kermen-Kyr (Chabion, 2,8k), Bulganak (Khaboi, 2,5k), Alma-Kermen (2,2k), Belogorsk-Ak-Kaya (2,8k), Zayachye (1,5k) and Dobroye (1,6k) [18][21][23].

Intervention by Mithridates VI Eupator's general Diophantus (110-107BC) rescued Chersonesus and integrated Crimea into the Pontic Empire before Roman hegemony was established after 63BC [16]. Under the Principate (first to third centuries AD), Rome stationed vexillations of Legions *I Italica*, *V Macedonica* and *XI Claudia* along with the *Classis Flavia Moesica* at the Chersonesus citadel, Balaklava-Kadykovka (Symbolon) and the cliff-top fortress of Charax on Cape Ai-Todor (1,8k troops and *canabae* residents at 200AD) [16][24]. Simultaneously, the Bosporan Kingdom under the Sarmatian-descended

Tibulii-Sauromates dynasty constructed heavy stone fortresses across the Kerch interior to guard against steppe incursions (Ilurat at 2,6k, Artesian at 2,1k, Mikhailovka at 1,8k and Tasunovo at 1,3k), bringing Crimea to its classical demographic apogee of 225k (225.000) in 200AD (78k in the south-western zone, 19k on the southern coast, 94k in the eastern Bosporan zone and 34k across the north-western steppe) [10][13].

The Gothic and Borani naval raids of 252-275AD (which sacked Tanais, Gorgippia, Ilurat, Myrmekion and the Late Scythian foothill citadels) and the subsequent Hunnic invasion across the Kerch Strait in 370-376AD (which destroyed the Bosporan rural *chora*, Scythian Neapolis and Ust-Alma) triggered a severe Late Antique demographic trough [23][25]. Regional population contracted to 155k in 300AD and bottomed out at 115k in 400AD (-48,9% below the 200AD peak), as survivors retreated behind the walls of Chersonesus and Bosporos or migrated into the forested valleys of the Crimean Mountains (where the Alanic-Gothic cemeteries of Neyzats, Opushki, Druzhnoye, Suuk-Su and Luchistoye mark the genesis of medieval Crimean Gothia) [25].

Medieval Crimea (500AD - 1400AD)

Byzantine Cherson, Gothia and the Khazars (500AD - 900AD)

Under Emperor Justinian I (527-565AD) and Maurice (582-602AD), Byzantium refortified Chersonesus (*Cherson*) and Bosporos, erected the coastal castles of Aluston (Alushta) and Gorzouvitai (Gurzuf) and constructed the *Long Walls* closing the mountain passes around the Gothic-Alanic federate territory of *Dory* [25][26]. Across the Inner Cuesta of south-western Crimea, Byzantine military engineers and local Christianised Gothic-Alanic communities founded the monumental cliff-top "cave-towns" (*peshchernye goroda*): Mangup-Doros (the 90 ha mesa plateau capital, rising from 2,5k in 500AD to 7k in 900AD), Eski-Kermen (18 ha plateau with a three-aisled basilica and rock-cut casemates, rising from 2,8k in 600AD to 5,2k in 900AD), Chufut-Kale (*Qirq-Yer*, 3,2k in 900AD), Bakla (3,4k in 900AD), Tepe-Kermen (2,4k), Kachi-Kalyon (2,1k), Kyz-Kermen (1,8k in 800AD) and Kalamita (Inkerman, 2k) [26][27][28]. Regional population recovered steadily from 125k in 500AD to 140k in 600AD and 160k in 700AD.

During the eighth and ninth centuries AD, the establishment of the Khazar Khaganate and its Crimean governorate (administered by the Khazar *tudun* at Bosporos, Sugdaia and periodically Cherson) ushered in the Saltovo-Mayaki demographic expansion documented by I. A. Baranov and A. I. Aibabin [29][30]. Semi-nomadic Proto-Bulgarian and Alanic pastoralists sedentarised across over 260 open villages, potteries and vineyards in Eastern and Foothill Crimea. Sugdaia (Sudak) emerged as a major trans-Pontic emporium (7,5k in 800AD and 9k in 900AD), flanked by the sprawling 18 ha coastal craft and monastic centre of Tepsen (Koktebel, 3,4k in 900AD), Kordon-Oba (1,8k), Otuz (Shchebetovka, 1,4k), Geroevskoye and Ptashkino on the Kerch Peninsula [29][31]. In Byzantine Cherson (elevated to the capital of the *Theme of Klimata/Cherson* under Emperor Theophilos in 833/841AD), urban population reached 11,5k - 12k in 800-900AD [32][33]. Total Crimean population climbed to 195k in 800AD and attained an early medieval peak of 215k in 900AD (74k in the south-west, 36k on the southern coast, 77k in the east and 28k in the north-west).

Kievan Rus and the Cumans (900AD - 1250AD)

The arrival of the Pechenegs in the Pontic steppes (c. 900-960AD) and Prince Svyatoslav Igorevich's destruction of the Khazar Khaganate (965AD) disrupted open Saltovo-Mayaki villages in Eastern Crimea and the Kerch steppe (including the burning of Tepsen and Kordon-Oba), causing regional population to contract to 190k in 1000AD and 185k in 1100AD [29][34]. Simultaneously, Crimea was drawn directly into the political and ecclesiastical orbit of Kievan Rus.

During the Korsun campaign of Vladimir the Great in 988-989AD, following a multi-month siege that severed the city's water pipes, Grand Prince Vladimir Svyatoslavich captured Byzantine Cherson (*Korsun*),

accepted baptism in the city's episcopal complex, married the Porphyrogenita princess Anna and returned Korsun to Emperor Basil II as his bride-gift while transferring priests, icons and bronze quadriga statues to Kiev [32][33]. Throughout the eleventh and twelfth centuries, Korsun (10k in 1000AD; 8k - 8,5k in 1100-1200AD) functioned as the premier Byzantine-Rus trade staple (*Korsuniane* merchants in Kiev and Novgorod). Across the Kerch Strait, in the Rus Principality of Tmutarakan and Korchev (988-1094AD), the Rurikid princes of Tmutarakan (Mstislav Vladimirovich, Gleb Svyatoslavich, Rostislav Vladimirovich and Oleg Svyatoslavich) ruled Korchev (ancient Bosporos/Kerch, 7,5k in 1000AD; 6,5k - 7k in 1100-1200AD), as commemorated by Prince Gleb's famous 1068AD *Tmutarakan Stone* measuring the 14.000-fathom ice crossing between Tmutarakan and Korchev [34].

By 1200AD, under the stable commercial condominium of the Polovtsians (Cumans), the Empire of Trebizond and the Seljuk Sultanate of Rum, Sugdaia (*Surozh* in Russian chronicles) reached 11k inhabitants as the chief silk-and-fur port of the Black Sea, while the fortified mountain towns of Gothia (Mangup at 7k, Eski-Kermen at 4,8k, Chufut-Kale at 3,8k, Bakla at 3k, Aluston at 3,5k and Gorzouvitai at 2,8k) expanded, lifting total Crimean population to 205k in 1200AD [28][33].

The Golden Horde, Genoese Gazaria and Theodoro (1223AD - 1400AD)

Mongol armies under Jebe and Subutai raided Sugdaia in January 1223AD, followed by Batu's conquest of the Crimean steppe in 1238-1239AD and Nogai's punitive campaign of 1299AD (which sacked Korsun, Eski-Kermen, Bakla and Sugdaia to avenge the killing of his grandson Aktaji) [33][35]. While the initial Mongol shock reduced Crimean population from 195k in 1240AD to a brief trough of 175k in 1250AD, the integration of Crimea into the trans-Eurasian *Pax Mongolica* as the western maritime gateway of the Golden Horde (*Ulus of Jochi*) generated a major urban and commercial boom by 1300AD (250k regional total).

Established in the sheltered Agarmysh valley of eastern Crimea as the seat of the Golden Horde *tumen-bashi* (governor of the Crimean *ulus*), Solkhat (*Qirim*, from which the entire peninsula took its name) grew into a 300 ha walled Islamic and multi-confessional metropolis featuring the Mosque of Sultan Baybars (1287-1288AD), the Mosque and Madrasa of Uzbek Khan (1314AD), Armenian and Greek churches, caravanserais, mints and hydraulic pipe networks [35][36][37]. At its 1300-1340AD zenith, Solkhat housed 28k (28.000) inhabitants (18k in 1400AD), complemented by the rising inland market city of Karasubazar (Bilohirsk, 8k in 1300AD and 7,5k in 1400AD) and the fortified cliff-top residence at Chufut-Kale (*Qirq-Yer*) and Eski-Yurt/Salachik in the Bakhchisaray valley (5,5k and 3,5k in 1300-1400AD) [38][39][40][41].

In Genoese Gazaria, following commercial concessions granted at ancient Theodosia by Mengu-Timur Khan in 1266AD, the Republic of Genoa transformed Caffa (Feodosia) into a massive double-walled maritime city enclosing 90 ha (a citadel and outer *burgh* with 26 towers protecting 11.000 - 15.000 urban plots and suburban *borghi* populated by Armenians, Greeks, Italians, Tatars, Jews and Rus) [37][42][43][44]. Prior to the outbreak of the Black Death during Janibeg Khan's siege of Caffa in 1346AD, Caffa housed 32k - 40k inhabitants at the 1300-1345AD peak (bringing the eastern Crimean sub-region to 96k in 1300AD). Genoa further acquired Cembalo (Balaklava, 1343/1357AD, 2,2k in 1300AD and 2,5k in 1400AD), Soldaia (Sudak, 1365AD, with its 18 coastal villages and monumental 14-tower fortress, 12k in 1300AD and 6,5k in 1400AD), Vosporo (Kerch, 5,5k in 1300AD and 4,5k in 1400AD) and the coastal castles of the *Capitanate of Gotthia* (Aluston/*Lusta* at 4k, Gorzouvitai at 3,2k, Partenit at 2,6k, Jalita/Yalta at 3k and Foros at 1,6k) [28][31][44][45].

In the south-western mountains and Belbek-Kacha-Chorna valleys, the Greek-Gothic dynasty of the Gabrades consolidated the Christian Principality of Theodoro, expanding the citadel and three-line defensive walls of Mangup (8,5k in 1300AD and 9k at the 1400AD benchmark), constructing the port fortress of Kalamita (Inkerman, 2,5k in 1400AD) to rival Genoese Cembalo and fortifying the eastern

border castle of Funa at the foot of Mount Demerdzhi alongside Syuyren, Kermenchik and Chorgun [27][28][35].

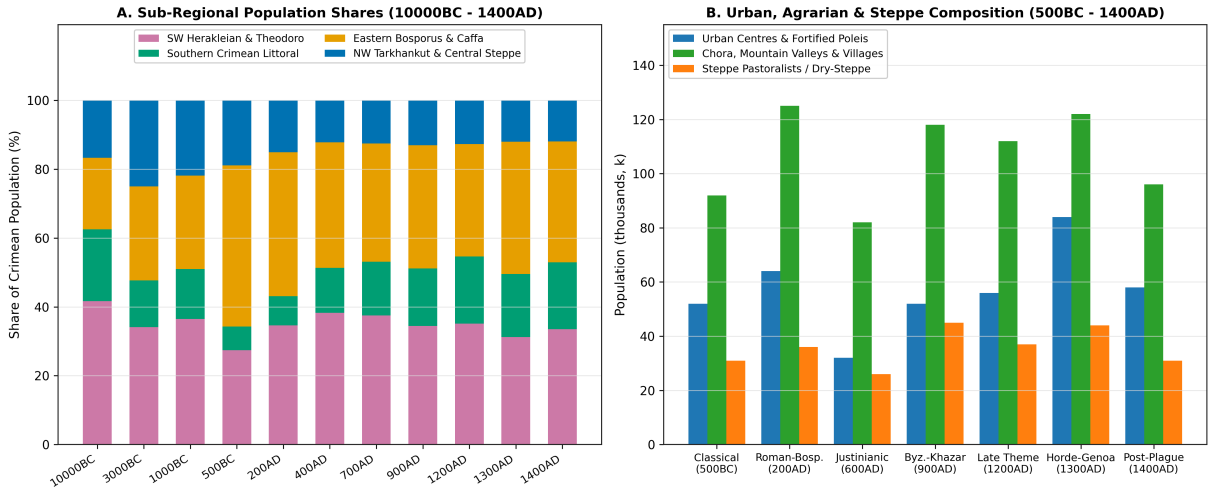


Figure 3. Sub-regional population shares and urban, agrarian and steppe shares across Crimea from 1000BC to 1400AD.

The Black Death and the 1400AD Benchmark

Recurrent waves of bubonic plague after Janibeg's 1346AD siege of Caffa, internecine warfare within the Golden Horde during the *Great Troubles* (*Velikaya Zamolnya*, 1359-1380AD, when Mamai controlled the Crimean *ulus*) and the campaigns of Timur (1395-1396AD) and Edigu (who besieged Korsun and sacked its remaining quarters in 1399AD) reduced Crimea's population from 250k in 1300AD to 185k at the 1400AD terminal benchmark (62k in the south-west, 36k on the southern coast, 65k in the east and 22k in the north-west; with urban populations at Caffa 22k, Solkhat 18k, Mangup 9k, Karasubazar 7,5k, Soldaia 6,5k, Qirq-Yer 5,5k, Vosporo 4,5k, Cembalo 2,5k and Korsun 2k) [35][42][46][47]. Because the subsequent secession of the independent Crimean Khanate under Haji I Giray (1441AD) and the Ottoman conquest of Caffa, Soldaia and Mangup (1475AD) initiated a distinct early modern fiscal and demographic regime, this review ends at 1400AD.

Regional Population Summary (10000BC - 1400AD)

Table 2 summarises the population series for Crimea (~26.945 km^2) and its four sub-regions from 10000BC to 1400AD.

Year	SW & Theodoro	South Coast	East & Bosporus	NW & Steppe	Total Pop.	Historical & Archaeological Context
10000BC	0,5k	0,25k	0,25k	0,2k	1,2k	Upper Palaeolithic/Early Shan-Koba Grottoes (Kiik-Koba, Siuren I, Buran-Kaya III)
8000BC	0,85k	0,45k	0,45k	0,35k	2,1k	Boreal Shan-Koba Mesolithic Foragers (Shan-Koba, Fatma-Koba, Grot Skalisty)

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Year	SW & Theodoro	South Coast	East & Bosporus	NW & Steppe	Total Pop.	Historical & Archaeological Context
6000BC	1,4k	0,75k	0,75k	0,6k	3,5k	Atlantic Murzak-Koba Mesolithic & Early Neolithic (Murzak-Koba, Laspi VII, Zamil-Koba)
5000BC	2,5k	1,2k	1,5k	1,3k	6,5k	Crimean Neolithic Expansion (Tash-Air I, Kaya-Arasy, Frontovoye I, At-Bash)
4000BC	4k	1,8k	2,8k	2,4k	11k	Eneolithic Steppe & Foothill Pastoralism (Sredny Stog & Early Copper Age)
3000BC	7,5k	3k	6k	5,5k	22k	Early Bronze Age Kemi-Oba Megalithic & Yamnaya Cultures (Kemi-Oba, Bakhchi-Eli)
2000BC	12k	4,5k	9,5k	9k	35k	Middle Bronze Age Catacomb & Late Kemi-Oba Settlements (Kamenka, Planerskoye)
1000BC	17,5k	7k	13k	10,5k	48k	Late Bronze/Early Iron Age Tauri Kizil-Koba Culture (Uch-Bash, Kizil-Koba)
500BC	48k	12k	82k	33k	175k	Archaic-Classical Greek Colonisation (Panticapaeum, Chersonesus, Theodosia, Kerkinitis)
0AD	72k	16k	88k	34k	210k	Hellenistic-Roman Transition & Late Scythian State (Scythian Neapolis, Ust-Alma)
200AD	78k	19k	94k	34k	225k	Roman Protectorate & Bosporan Apogee (Charax, Chersonesus 20k, Panticapaeum 28k)
300AD	56k	16k	61k	22k	155k	Post-Gothic Raid Contraction (Destruction of Tanais, Ilurat & Scythian Foothill Forts)
400AD	44k	15k	42k	14k	115k	Post-Hunnic Trough (370-376AD Collapse of Bosporan Chora & Migration into Mountains)

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Year	SW & Theodoro	South Coast	East & Bosporus	NW & Steppe	Total Pop.	Historical & Archaeological Context
500AD	48k	18k	44k	15k	125k	Early Byzantine Reconquest under Anastasius & Justinian I (Aluston, Gorzouvitai, Doros)
600AD	54k	21k	48k	17k	140k	Byzantine Exarchate & Rise of Gothic Cave-Towns (Mangup, Eski-Kermen, Chufut-Kale)
700AD	60k	25k	55k	20k	160k	Early Khazar Condominium & Crimean Tudunate (Cherson, Bosporos, Sugdaia)
800AD	68k	32k	70k	25k	195k	Saltovo-Mayaki Sedentarisation Boom (260+ Eastern & Foothill Villages, Tepsen)
900AD	74k	36k	77k	28k	215k	Byzantine Theme of Klimata/Cherson & Khazar Apogee (Cherson 12k, Sugdaia 9k)
1000AD	68k	34k	64k	24k	190k	Kievan Rus Korsun Campaign (988AD) & Tmutarakan-Korchev Principality (Post-Khazar Shift)
1100AD	65k	35k	61k	24k	185k	Cuman (Polovtsian) Steppe Hegemony & Byzantine-Rus Trade at Korsun and Korchev
1200AD	72k	40k	67k	26k	205k	Pre-Mongol Commercial Recovery (Sugdaia/Surozh 11k, Mangup 7k, Korsun 8k)
1240AD	69k	38k	64k	24k	195k	Initial Mongol Incursions (1223AD & 1238-1239AD Steppe Campaigns)
1250AD	63k	35k	56k	21k	175k	Post-Conquest Transition & Early Ulus of Jochi Reorganisation
1300AD	78k	46k	96k	30k	250k	Golden Horde Solkhat (28k) & Genoese Caffa (32k) Maritime Apogee (despite 1299AD Raid)

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Year	SW & Theodoro	South Coast	East & Bosporus	NW & Steppe	Total Pop.	Historical & Archaeological Context
1400AD	62k	36k	65k	22k	185k	Post-1346AD Black Death, Horde Civil Wars & 1395-1399AD Timur/Edigu Raids; Theodoro Peak

Table 2. Regional population estimates for Crimea across its four physiographic sub-regions from 10000BC to 1400AD.

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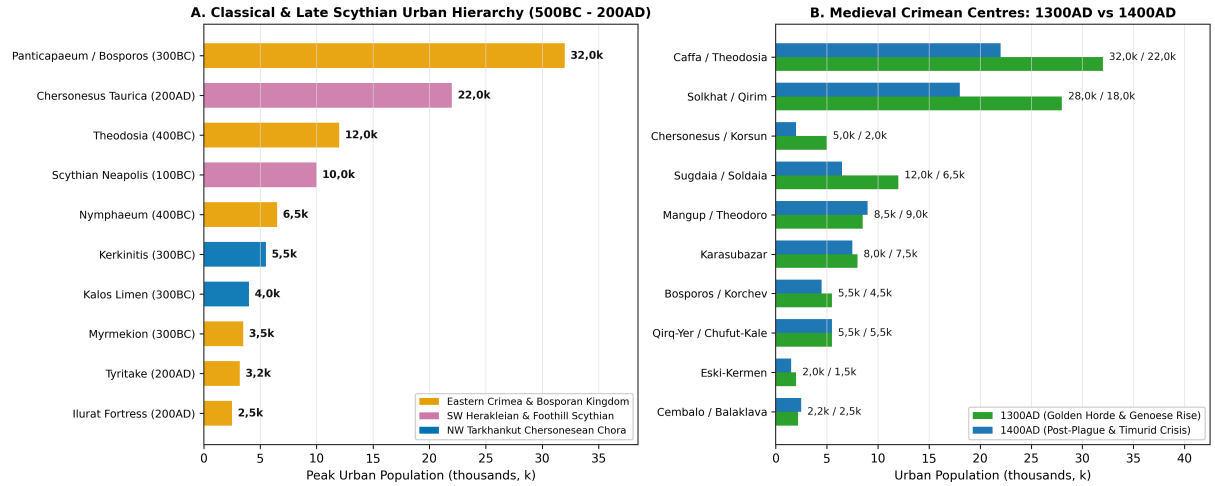


Figure 4. Urban population hierarchy of Crimea comparing Classical and Late Scythian poleis (500BC - 200AD) with medieval centres (1300 - 1400AD).

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